

Sleep and Dreaming	Content
Key Concepts	- The functions, features and benefits of sleep: healthy brain; physical repair; emotional stability; <u>stages of the sleep cycle and when dreaming occurs</u>; <u>the role of the pineal gland and melatonin</u> - The causes of sleep disorders: sleep onset and sleep maintenance insomnia - Endogenous pacemakers; and exogenous zeitgebers; and their role in sleep.
Theories/Explanations: The Nature of Dreaming The Freudian Theory of Dreaming The Activation Synthesis Theory of Dreaming	- The Freudian Theory of Dreaming: - the unconscious mind - the role of repression - the concept of wish fulfilment - manifest and latent content of dreams - criticisms of the theory including the issue of subjectivity. The Freudian Theory of Dreaming Research Study – Freud (1918): dream analysis study of ‘The Wolfman’. - The Activation Synthesis Theory of Dreaming: - the role of REM sleep <u>the function and actions of the brain during sleep, including the limbic system</u> <u>activity of neurons in the pons during sleep</u> <u>the process of synthesis as a function of the cerebral cortex</u> - criticisms of the theory including the reductionism/holism debate. The Activation Synthesis Theory of Dreaming Research Study <u>Differences in actions and functions of the brain when dreaming and when awake</u> – Williams et al. (1992): study into Bizarreness in Dreams and Fantasies: Implications for the Activation Synthesis Hypothesis.
Application Development of treatments for insomnia	- Features of insomnia, <u>the role of the nervous system and its management through relaxation techniques</u> and the role of the physical environment in insomnia and its treatment through improved sleep hygiene <u>The impact of neurological damage to the hypothalamus on sleep.</u>